A PHONICS & PRONUNCIATION ACTIVITY BOOK

SOUND EXPLORERS

Build sounds. Blend words. Read with confidence.



LISTEN BLEND READ SAY

For preparatory program students
Salalah Vocational College

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Bright ideas. Small steps. Stronger reading.

START HERE

Your sound journey

A little practice, repeated often. Work with a teacher or a reading partner.

This book belongs to me

Name: _____

Group: _____ Start date: _____

1 Explore the six stations

01 **Sound starters** 3-6

02 **Short-vowel street** 7-13

03 **Blend & digraph bridge** 14-19

04 **Vowel-pattern park** 20-26

05 **Clear-speech studio** 27-32

06 **Play, check & celebrate** 33-35

Your 10-minute practice plan

2 min: listen and copy the sounds. **3 min:** point and blend.
3 min: read, sort or write. **2 min:** reread and do the exit ticket.
Say, “Please model it again,” whenever you need help.

Teacher pages and answer key: 36-40. Start at the page that matches your needs. Revisit any sound that is still difficult.

★ **EXIT TICKET**

My goal: I want to read _____ more clearly.

SOUND STARTERS

Letters are clues to sounds

Listen first. Point to the letters. Say the sounds. Blend from left to right.

A name is not a sound

The letter name of **m** is “em”.
Its sound in **map** is /m/.
Keep the sound clean: /m/, without an extra “uh”.

One sound, one box

A sound may use one letter:
m in map.
Or two letters:
sh in ship.

1 Stretch and blend

Keep moving through the word. Then say the whole word naturally.

map

m	a	p

map

Listen: /m/ - /æ/ - /p/. Then blend: map.

2 Tap, blend, then write

Say “sit”. Tap one finger for each sound. Write one sound in each box.

sit

Reading partner rule

Model one word. Let your partner try. Help kindly. Reread together.

★ **EXIT TICKET**

In “map”, I can hear _____ sounds.

START CHECK

My starting point

Try first without help. This is a practice check, not a grade. Your teacher records it.

1 Say these sounds

Point to each letter or letter group. Say a sound it can represent.

m	**s**	**a**	**i**	**sh**

2 Read these ten words

Sound out unfamiliar words. Read independently before your teacher helps.

map	**pen**	**sit**	**hot**	**sun**
stop	**fish**	**rain**	**home**	**tool**

3 Listen and write

Your teacher will say five words. Write what you hear.

1. _____ **2.** _____ **3.** _____ **4.** _____ **5.** _____

Record with your teacher

Date: _____ Sounds: ___ / 5 Words: ___ / 10 Spelling: ___ / 5
A sound I will practise: _____

★ **EXIT TICKET**

Today I feel: ready to try / a little unsure / excited.

SOUND STARTERS

Meet the consonants

Copy the first sound in each keyword. Do not add an extra vowel after it.

s sun	**m** map	**n** net	**f** fan
l lip	**r** red	**t** tap	**p** pin
b bag	**d** dog	**k** kit	**c** cat

Feel the difference

Stretch **s, m, n, f, l, r**. Keep **t, p, b, d, k** short.
In **cat** and **kit**, c and k represent the same sound /k/.

1 Circle the first-sound letter

Say each word. Then circle the letter for its first sound.

map: n / m

fan: f / v

bag: p / b

sun: s / t

★ **EXIT TICKET**

Pick three letters. Say a keyword for each one.

More sound clues

Listen to your teacher. These are common sounds; letters can have other sounds too.

g	**gap**	**h**	**hat**	**j**	**jet**
v	**van**	**w**	**wet**	**y**	**yes**
z	**zip**	**x**	**box**	**qu**	**quit**

Look closely

In **box**, x represents **two sounds**: /k/ + /s/.
In **quit**, qu represents /k/ + /w/. Listen and copy.
The letter y is /j/ at the start of **yes**. It has other jobs in **my**.

1 Finish the sound clue

Choose: g, h, j, v, w or z. Use each once. Say the complete word.

___an	___et	___ip
___at	___eb	___ap

EXIT TICKET

Say “box”. The letter x represents _____ sounds.

Short a: bag

Hear the middle sound. Blend the sounds. Read the whole word.

a **/æ/**

Open your mouth fairly wide. Listen to the middle sound in bag.



1 Point, blend and read

bag	**map**	**tap**
cap	**fan**	**mat**

2 Fill the middle sound

b _ g **m _ p** **t _ p**

3 Circle words with short a

bag / big **pen / pan** **cap / cup**

A bag. A map. A cap.

Circle the item you wear on your head.

EXIT TICKET

Read one word. Cover it. Say its sounds. Write it: _____

Short e: pen

Hear the middle sound. Blend the sounds. Read the whole word.

e **/e/**

Relax your lips. Listen to the middle sound in pen.



1 Point, blend and read

pen	net	hen
bed	red	ten

2 Fill the middle sound

p _ n n _ t b _ d

3 Circle words with short e

pin / pen bed / bad ten / tin

A red pen. A red hen.

Underline the colour word both times.

EXIT TICKET

Read one word. Cover it. Say its sounds. Write it: _____

Short i: pin

Hear the middle sound. Blend the sounds. Read the whole word.

i /ɪ/

Keep the vowel short and relaxed.
Listen to the middle sound in pin.



1 Point, blend and read

pin	sit	lip
bin	kit	six

2 Fill the middle sound

p _ n s _ t b _ n

3 Circle words with short i

sit / set bag / big pin / pan

A big bin. A pin in a tin.

Circle the word that names a small metal container.

EXIT TICKET

Read one word. Cover it. Say its sounds. Write it: _____

Short o: pot

Hear the middle sound. Blend the sounds. Read the whole word.

O **/ɒ/**

In the British model, round your lips.
Listen to the middle sound in pot.



1 Point, blend and read

pot	**hot**	**top**
hop	**log**	**dog**

2 Fill the middle sound

p _ t **h _ t** **d _ g**

3 Circle words with short o

hat / hot **top / tap** **pig / dog**

A hot pot. A dog on a log.

Underline the word that tells you the pot is not cold.

EXIT TICKET

Read one word. Cover it. Say its sounds. Write it: _____

Short u: cup

Hear the middle sound. Blend the sounds. Read the whole word.

u /ʌ/

Relax your mouth. Listen to the middle sound in cup.



1 Point, blend and read

cup	sun	bus
run	mud	nut

2 Fill the middle sound

c _ p s _ n b _ s

3 Circle words with short u

cup / cap sin / sun ran / run

A cup. A nut. A bus in mud.

Circle the thing you can drink from.

★ **EXIT TICKET**

Read one word. Cover it. Say its sounds. Write it: _____

SHORT-VOWEL STREET

The vowel sorting lab

Read each word before you sort it. Listen to the middle sound.

Word bank

map • pen • sit • hot • sun • cap • net • pin • log • cup

1 Sort the ten words

Write two words under each vowel. Read each column to a partner.

a	e	i	o	u
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____

2 Sound detectives

Listen to five words. Write the missing vowel, then read the word.

b _ g **r _ d** **f _ n** **d _ g** **c _ p**

3 Make one word

Choose a first sound, a vowel and a last sound. Write a real word.

First: m, p, t, s **Middle:** a, i, o **Last:** p, n, t

_____

EXIT TICKET

The vowel I want to practise again is _____.

Build it. Switch it. Read it.

One sound changes. A new word appears. Say each word before you write.

1 Follow the word chain

map	Change m to t.	_____
tap	Change a to i.	_____
tip	Change t to s.	_____
sip	Change p to t.	_____

2 Say it. Tap it. Map it.

Write one sound in each box. These words have three sounds.

sun ☐☐☐ **pen** ☐☐☐ **map** ☐☐☐

3 Add a sound

at + m at the start = _____

★ **EXIT TICKET**

Read your word chain again without stopping between sounds.

BLEND BRIDGE

Keep every sound

In a consonant blend, you can still hear each sound. Do not insert an extra vowel.

Listen: s + t + o + p = stop

The first two sounds stay close together: /s/ /t/.
Say **stop** in one syllable. Do not start it with “es”.

1 Point and blend

stop	**spin**	**skip**
flag	**clip**	**drum**

2 Match the start to the ending

Draw lines to make the three words: stop, flag and drum.

st	**um**
fl	**op**
dr	**ag**

Read and act

Stop. Spin. Clip a tag. Your teacher models the actions.

EXIT TICKET

Say “stop”. I can hear _____ sounds.

BLEND BRIDGE

Finish the word clearly

Keep the sounds at the end. Say one syllable; do not add “uh” after the last sound.

1 Read and underline the last two letters

hand	tent	lamp
belt	desk	mask

2 Choose the ending

Complete each word with nd, nt, mp, lt, sk or st. Use each once.

ha___	te___	la___
be___	de___	ne___

3 Blend four sounds

Tap each sound as you read. Then say the word smoothly.

hand

h	a	n	d

lamp

l	a	m	p

★ **EXIT TICKET**

Read “tent” and “desk”. Keep both ending sounds.

DIGRAPH BRIDGE

Two letters, one sound

A digraph is two letters that represent one sound. Keep the letters together.

sh /ʃ/

Lips gently forward. Let the air flow.
ship shop fish

ch /tʃ/

Start with a quick stop, then release.
chip chop much

1 Blend with sound boxes

ship

sh	i	p

chip

ch	i	p

2 Read, then circle sh or ch

ship: sh / ch

chip: sh / ch

fish: sh / ch

much: sh / ch

3 Build a phrase

Choose a word from this page. Write a phrase and read it to a partner.

EXIT TICKET

“ship” has 4 letters and _____ sounds.

DIGRAPH BRIDGE

Try the two th sounds

Put your tongue lightly between your teeth. Let air pass. Watch and copy your teacher.

th as in thin /θ/

No voice buzz.
Touch your throat gently.
thin thick bath moth
Listen for air, not /s/ or /t/.

th as in this /ð/

Switch your voice on.
Feel a gentle throat buzz.
this that them then
Keep the tongue position.

1 Read and sort

Write each word in the matching column: thin, this, that, moth, then, thick.

No buzz: thin

.....

.....

.....

Buzz: this

.....

.....

.....

2 Mirror practice

Read each phrase slowly. Then read it naturally.

this thin pin

that thick mat

★ **EXIT TICKET**

Circle the word with a voice buzz: thin / this

DIGRAPH BRIDGE

Sound teams to remember

Count sounds, not letters. Some letter teams represent one sound.

ng as in ring /ŋ/

Keep the back of your tongue up.
In **ring**, do not add a /g/.
ring sing long bang

ck as in lock /k/

c and k work as one sound.
Tap three sounds in **lock**.
lock neck back sock

Double letters, one consonant sound

ff: off **ll:** bell **ss:** mess **zz:** buzz
Say the consonant sound once. These words have two or three sounds.

1 Write one sound in each box

ring

lock

2 Circle the number of sounds

bell: 3 / 4

off: 2 / 3

sock: 3 / 4

sing: 3 / 4

EXIT TICKET

Name two spellings that can represent /k/.

READ & CONNECT

Checkpoint: at the shop

Read the helper words with your teacher. Then blend the other words and reread.

HELPER WORDS: the, a

A man has a shop.

The shop has a big red lamp.

A cat sits on a mat.

The man taps the bell.

The cat jumps off the mat.

1 Read and find

Underline two words with sh. Circle two words with double letters.

2 Show you understand

1. What colour is the lamp? _____

2. What does the man tap? _____

3 Listen and spell

Your teacher will say three words from today’s learning.

_____ _____ _____

★ **EXIT TICKET**

I reread: once / twice / three times. One easier word: _____

The quiet e changes a vowel

In these words, final e is silent. The vowel uses its letter-name sound.

a_e as in name /eɪ/

cap → cape
tap → tape

i_e as in time /aɪ/

pin → pine
kit → kite

1 Read both words. Hear the change.

mat / mate

mad / made

rid / ride

2 Add e and write the new word

tap → _____

cap → _____

pin → _____

Word detective: This pattern is common, but not a rule for every word. **Have** is different; learn it with a teacher model.

EXIT TICKET

Read: cap, cape. Which word has silent e? _____

More quiet-e words

Point to the vowel and final e. Listen, blend and say the whole word.

o_e as in home /əʊ/

hop → hope
not → note
rod → rode
The final e has no sound.

u_e: two common sounds

cube, cute, mule: /juː/
flute, rule: /uː/
Listen to the whole word.
Both patterns have silent e.

1 Circle the word for the meaning

1. A place to live: home / hop

2. A short written message: not / note

3. A musical instrument: flute / flat

2 Sort these words

Write: home, cube, note, rule, cute, flute.

o_e	u_e: /juː/	u_e: /uː/
.....	.....	.....
.....	.....	.....

EXIT TICKET

Read “home”. The final e is spoken / silent.

VOWEL-PATTERN PARK

Vowels can work together

These letter teams have the sounds shown in these examples.

ai as in rain

rain train paint

ay as in day

day play tray

ee as in green

green feet see

ea as in team

team clean read

1 Choose the team

Use ai, ay, ee or ea. Copy the spelling from the example cards.

r___n pl___ f___t

t___m tr___n cl___n

2 Read and draw

Draw a green tray. Then read the phrase to a partner.

a green tray

★ **EXIT TICKET**

In “head”, ea is different. Ask your teacher to model it.

VOWEL-PATTERN PARK

Find a vowel pattern

Read the examples. The same sound can have more than one spelling.

oa / ow: sound in go

boat coat road
snow slow grow
Here, ow has the sound in go.

igh / y: sound in my

light night high
my fly dry
igh is three letters, one sound.

1 Sort by vowel sound

Write: coat, fly, snow, night, road, dry.

Sound in go

_____

_____

_____

Sound in my

_____

_____

_____

2 Read, choose and write

1. A warm _____. (coat / night)

2. A bright _____. (road / light)

3. A _____ day. (dry / fly)

★ **EXIT TICKET**

Underline the letter team in “night”.

VOWEL-PATTERN PARK

Same letters, different sounds

The letters oo do not always have the same sound. Listen to your teacher and copy.

oo as in moon /uː/

Round your lips.
moon food room tool
Hold the vowel gently.

oo as in book /ʊ/

Keep your lips more relaxed.
book look cook good
Make a short, relaxed vowel.

1 Build two word collections

Write: room, book, tool, cook, food, good.

Moon sound

Book sound

2 Read and mark

Underline oo. Read each line with your teacher.

Look at the book.
A tool in a room.
Good food.

EXIT TICKET

Circle the word with the vowel in “book”: food / cook

Let your vowel move

A gliding vowel changes mouth position within one syllable. Watch, listen and copy.

ou / ow as in out /aʊ/

out loud shout
now cow town
Start open; move towards rounded lips.

oi / oy as in boy /ɔɪ/

oil coin boil
boy toy enjoy
Start rounded; move towards relaxed lips.

1 Choose the correct letters

Choose from ou, ow, oi and oy. Look at the example cards.

c___n	t___n	b___
l___d	t___	___t

2 Read the ow words twice

One spelling, two sounds

snow, slow, grow: the vowel sound in go.
now, cow, town: the vowel sound in out.
Circle the word with the different vowel:
snow cow slow

★ **EXIT TICKET**

Read: coin, boy. Do their vowel sounds match? yes / no

VOWEL-PATTERN PARK

Vowels next to r

Follow your teacher’s accent model. British and American r sounds may differ.

ar as in car

car park start
British model: /ɑː/

or as in fork

fork short storm
British model: /ɔː/

er, ir, ur: the sound in her

her term • bird first • turn burn
These examples share a vowel sound in the model used here: /ɜː/.
In accents that pronounce r, include that r sound.

1 Sort the words

Write: park, fork, her, bird, turn, storm.

car sound	fork sound	her sound

2 Read the instruction

Turn first. Start the car.

★ **EXIT TICKET**

Find two spellings for the vowel sound in “her”: ____ ____

CLEAR-SPEECH STUDIO

Make the difference clear

Practise only the contrasts you need. The aim is clear meaning, not changing your identity.

Feel and compare

/p/ and /b/: close both lips; release. /p/ has a puff of air at the start of **pin**. /b/ uses voice in **bin**.
/f/ and /v/: top teeth touch the lower lip. /f/ has air; /v/ adds voice.
/s/ and /z/: keep air moving. /z/ adds a voice buzz.

1 Listen. Circle the word you hear.

Your teacher reads one word from each pair. Then repeat the chosen word.

1. **pin / bin**
2. **cap / cab**
3. **fan / van**
4. **fine / vine**
5. **sip / zip**
6. **bus / buzz**

2 Partner message

Choose a word from a pair. Say it without pointing. Your partner points to it.

Try again kindly

If your partner points to the other word, listen to a model and try again.

★ **EXIT TICKET**

The pair I want to practise is _____ / _____.

Small vowel, big difference

Listen to vowel quality as well as length. Copy the mouth shape and sound.

1 Listen and circle

Your teacher reads one word from each pair. Circle it. Then read both words.

1. ship / sheep	short i / ee
2. sit / seat	short i / ea
3. fill / feel	short i / ee
4. pull / pool	book vowel / moon vowel

2 Read in a phrase

a big ship / a white sheep

sit here / a seat here

pull the bag / a pool

★ **EXIT TICKET**

Circle the pair you can now say clearly: ship/sheep or pull/pool.

Break long words into beats

A syllable is a spoken beat. The stressed beat is stronger. Clap gently as you say it.

Listen, tap and join

HEL-met SPAN-ner SAFE-ty WORK-shop
Each word has two syllables. Capitals show the stronger syllable.
Read the whole word after practising the beats.

1 Count the spoken beats

Say each word with your teacher. Write 1, 2 or 3.

lamp ____

helmet ____

computer ____

workshop ____

tool ____

safety ____

2 Mark the stronger beat

Circle the stressed syllable. Your teacher models each word.

hel / met

com / pu / ter

e / lec / tric

Try it in a sentence: Put the helmet in the workshop.

EXIT TICKET

Write one two-syllable word you know: _____

Do not lose the endings

Listen to the final sound before the ending. The spelling alone does not tell the whole story.

Plural -s / -es: three sounds

/s/: caps, hats - after a voiceless sound such as /p/ or /t/.
/z/: pens, bags - after a vowel or a voiced sound such as /n/ or /g/.
/ɪz/: buses, boxes - after /s/, /z/, /ʃ/, /ʒ/, /tʃ/ or /dʒ/.
Only /ɪz/ adds a syllable. Listen: bus → buses.

Past -ed: three sounds

/t/: looked, washed - after voiceless sounds other than /t/.
/d/: cleaned, played - after vowels or voiced sounds other than /d/.
/ɪd/: wanted, needed - after /t/ or /d/.
Only /ɪd/ adds a syllable. Listen: need → needed.

1 Choose the ending sound

caps: /s/ /z/ /ɪz/

pens: /s/ /z/ /ɪz/

boxes: /s/ /z/ /ɪz/

looked: /t/ /d/ /ɪd/

played: /t/ /d/ /ɪd/

wanted: /t/ /d/ /ɪd/

★ **EXIT TICKET**

Clap “washed” and “wanted”. Which has two beats? _____

READ & CONNECT

Some words need a memory clue

Use the sound clues you know. Ask your teacher to model the unexpected part.

the	**a**	**is**
was	**to**	**of**
you	**said**	**have**

Look, say, cover, write, check

1. Look at **said**. Say it with your teacher: /sed/.
2. Notice that **ai** represents the vowel in **bed** here.
3. Cover the word. Write it: _____
4. Uncover and check. Read it in: **She said yes.**

1 Read a useful message

Listen to a model, read together, then read on your own.

1. **Put the tools in the box.**
2. **You have a red pen.**
3. **This is a safe place to sit.**

2 Copy one message. Read it aloud.

EXIT TICKET

The helper word I want to remember is _____.

READ & CONNECT

A bright start in the workshop

Supported reading: your teacher models new words first. Read for meaning, then fluency.

Meet the new words

Salim • checks • neat • shuts
Read the helper words again: the, a, is, to, of.

Salim is in the workshop. He has a box of tools and a green bag. He checks the lamp. The light is bright.

Salim puts the tools in the box. He shuts the lid. Then he puts the box on a shelf. The workshop is neat. It is time to go home.

1 Read it three ways

1. **Echo:** listen to one sentence, then repeat it.
2. **Partner:** take turns reading a sentence.
3. **Solo:** reread with clear endings and short pauses.

2 Check the meaning

What colour is the bag? _____ Where is the box at the end?

_____

EXIT TICKET

Underline two vowel teams in the story. Read those words.

PLAY & PRACTISE

Sound trail challenge

For two players: use a coin and two small counters. Read clearly; speed is not the goal.

How to play

Start before square 1. Flip a coin: heads = move 1; tails = move 2.
Read your square. If you need help, hear a model and read it again.
On a ★ square, also say the word in a phrase. Stop at FINISH.

1 **map** →	2 **ship** →	3 **train** →	4 ★ **tool**
8 ★ **home** ←	7 **green** ←	6 **stop** ←	5 **cap**
9 **fish** →	10 **light** →	11 **coin** →	12 ★ **turn**
16 ★ **room** ←	15 **night** ←	14 **desk** ←	13 **bag**
17 **thin** →	18 **flute** →	19 **shout** →	20 **FINISH**

After the game: choose three words and write a short message together.

★ **EXIT TICKET**

My clearest word today was _____. My next word is _____.

PROGRESS CHECK

Look how far you have come

Try independently first. Your teacher records the result and helps you plan the next step.

1 Say these sounds again

m	**s**	**a**	**i**	**sh**

2 Read the same ten words

map	**pen**	**sit**	**hot**	**sun**
stop	**fish**	**rain**	**home**	**tool**

3 Listen and write again

Your teacher says the same five words from the start check.

1. _____ **2.** _____ **3.** _____ **4.** _____ **5.** _____

Compare your own progress

Date: _____ Sounds: ___ / 5 Words: ___ / 10 Spelling: ___ / 5
My word score on page 4: ____ / 10. My word score now: ____ / 10.
New-word transfer: read **flat, chain, boat, dark** with your teacher.
A pattern to practise next: _____

★ **EXIT TICKET**

I am proud that I can now _____.

CELEBRATE & CONTINUE

My sound explorer passport

Notice your progress. Ask your teacher to tick a skill when you can show it independently.

- [ ] I can say a sound for a letter.
- [ ] I can blend a short word from left to right.
- [ ] I can hear and write sounds in a word.
- [ ] I keep the sounds in consonant blends.
- [ ] I recognise common digraphs and vowel teams.
- [ ] I can read a short message with clear endings.

SOUND EXPLORER

A record of effort, practice and progress

Name: _____

Teacher: _____ Date: _____

1 Keep the habit

My practice days: _____

My next three words: _____

My reading partner: _____

EXIT TICKET

I can pause, listen, try again and keep learning.

TEACHER SUPPORT

Teacher guide

Use the booklet as targeted support. It is not a complete validated phonics programme.

A consistent teaching routine

Model → practise together → independent try → feedback → reread.
Use clean consonant sounds without an added schwa. Stretch continuous sounds where helpful; keep stop sounds brief. Blend through the word from left to right. Use one box per phoneme, not per letter.

Adapt for preparatory program students

Start with the check on page 4. Revisit only the patterns the learner needs. Preteach word meanings through objects, mime or pictures. Give spoken models before pair work. Pictures support meaning; they should not replace decoding. Repeat a short section before introducing more patterns. Prioritise accuracy and confidence over speed.

Accent and pronunciation notes

The IPA examples mainly follow a British model. Short o may be /ɑ/ in American English; long o may be /oʊ/. Accept consistent accent differences, including rhotic r. /e/ is also written /ɛ/ in some dictionaries. Long-vowel labels are teaching labels, not instructions to lengthen a short vowel. Teach mouth position and sound quality.

Using the reading texts

Model **a, the** before early phrases. On page 19, model the /z/ in **has**; review plural/verb -s briefly. Page 32 is supported reading, not a strictly decodable text. Preteach all unfamiliar words, including the name Salim. No recorded audio is embedded; teacher read-aloud scripts follow.

Printing: A4 portrait at 100%. For duplex printing, use long-edge binding. Teacher support and answer keys begin here; separate these pages if desired.

TEACHER SUPPORT

Read-aloud scripts & checks

Read naturally, repeat once and allow writing time. Do not show the scripted answers first.

Pages 4 and 34: same baseline and final check

Sounds: m, s, short a, short i, sh. Accept the intended phonemes, not letter names. **Reading:** use the printed ten words.
Dictation: map, pen, sit, hot, sun. Say each word, use it in a short sentence if needed, then say the word again.

Page 12: vowel dictation

Say these words: **bag, red, fin, dog, cup**.
Students supply: **a, e, i, o, u**. Clarify fin with a picture or gesture.

Page 19: checkpoint dictation

Read: **shop, bell, lamp**. Students write the complete words.

Page 27: consonant contrasts

Read one word per numbered pair, in order:
1 bin · 2 cap · 3 van · 4 fine · 5 zip · 6 buzz
Then model both words in each pair for comparison.

Page 28: vowel contrasts

Read in order: **1 sheep · 2 sit · 3 feel · 4 pull**.
Then practise both words in each pair. Model quality as well as length.

Scoring: one point for each independently correct sound, word or spelling. Allow self-correction. Record supported attempts separately. Compare each learner with their own baseline; this is not a standardised test. The same-word recheck shows practice gains; use the four new words on page 34 to explore transfer without adding them to the score.

TEACHER SUPPORT

Answer key: sound starters

Oral responses and personal choices vary. Check the targeted sound as well as the writing.

Page 3 sit: s | i | t. Exit: 3 sounds.

Page 5 map: m; fan: f; bag: b; sun: s. Exit: any three correct keywords.

Page 6 van, jet, zip, hat, web, gap. Exit: 2 sounds (/k/ + /s/).

Page 7 Fill: a, a, a. Circle: bag, pan, cap. Wear on your head: cap.

Page 8 Fill: e, e, e. Circle: pen, bed, ten. Underline red twice.

Page 9 Fill: i, i, i. Circle: sit, big, pin. Container: tin.

Page 10 Fill: o, o, o. Circle: hot, top, dog. Underline hot.

Page 11 Fill: u, u, u. Circle: cup, sun, run. Drink from: cup.

Page 12 a: map, cap; e: pen, net; i: sit, pin; o: hot, log; u: sun, cup. Dictation: bag, red, fin, dog, cup. New word: e.g. mat, pin, top, sit.

Page 13 tap → tip → sip → sit. Boxes: s | u | n; p | e | n; m | a | p. Add m to at: mat.

Note on short-vowel tasks: Students choose by the sound they hear, not only by the vowel letter. Use the teacher model when a word is unfamiliar.

TEACHER SUPPORT

Answer key: blends & vowels

For open tasks, accept any meaningful response with the target pattern read correctly.

Page 14 st + op; fl + ag; dr + um. Exit: stop has 4 sounds.

Page 15 Last letters: nd, nt, mp, lt, sk, sk. Fill: hand, tent, lamp, belt, desk, nest.

Page 16 sh, ch, sh, ch. Phrases vary. Exit: ship has 3 sounds.

Page 17 No buzz /θ/: thin, moth, thick. Buzz /ð/: this, that, then. Exit: this.

Page 18 Boxes: r | i | ng; l | o | ck. Counts: bell 3, off 2, sock 3, sing 3. Exit: any two of c, k, ck.

Page 19 sh: shop (any two occurrences). Double letters: bell, off. Lamp: red. The man taps the bell. Dictation: shop, bell, lamp.

Page 20 tape, cape, pine. Exit: cape.

Page 21 home; note; flute. Sort: o_e - home, note; /juː/ - cube, cute; /uː/ - rule, flute. Exit: silent.

Page 22 rain, play, feet, team, train, clean. Drawing: a green tray. Head has /e/.

Page 23 go sound: coat, snow, road. my sound: fly, night, dry. Fill: coat, light, dry. Underline igh.

Page 24 Moon: room, tool, food. Book: book, cook, good. Exit: cook.

Page 25 coin, town, boy, loud, toy, out. Different vowel: cow. Exit: yes.

TEACHER SUPPORT

Answer key & next steps

Use each learner’s errors to select a small next step. Revisit, model and reread.

Page 26 car sound: park. fork sound: fork, storm. her sound: her, bird, turn. Exit: any two of er, ir, ur.

Pages 27-28 Listening answers are on page 37. Partner and self-reflection responses vary.

Page 29 Syllables: 1, 2, 3, 2, 1, 2. Stress: HEL-met; com-PU-ter; e-LEC-tric. Exit: any valid two-syllable word.

Page 30 caps /s/; pens /z/; boxes /ɪz/; looked /t/; played /d/; wanted /ɪd/. Exit: wanted.

Page 31 Copy: said. Copied message and chosen helper word vary.

Page 32 The bag is green. The box is on a shelf. Vowel teams include ee in green, igh in light/bright, oo in tools.

Pages 33-35 Game, personal reflections and goals vary. Page 34: use the page 37 scoring guidance. Ask the learner to demonstrate a skill before ticking the passport.

Teacher references & optional sound models

Original activities prepared for this booklet. The general use of letter-sound links, oral blending and rereading is informed by the Department for Education’s The reading framework; it is school guidance, not validation of this booklet for adult EFL learners.

DfE: The reading framework

British Council: LearnEnglish Sounds Right - optional audio models.

Sources checked: 2 October 2026. External resources may require internet access.

Keep the focus on clear, confident communication.